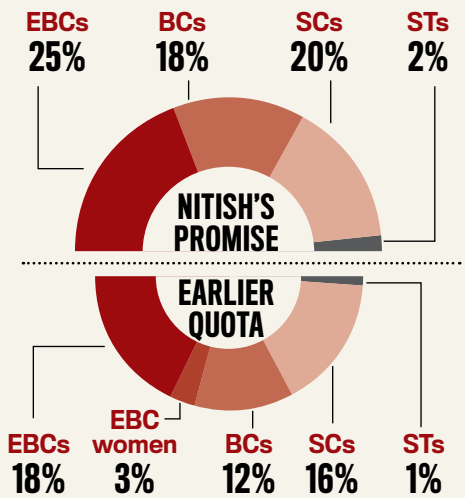
ANI



Caste survey in progress in Patna

AFFIRMATIVE ACTION

Bihar will now have 65 per cent reservations from 50 per cent earlier for the underprivileged, besides the 10 per cent quota for the economically weak



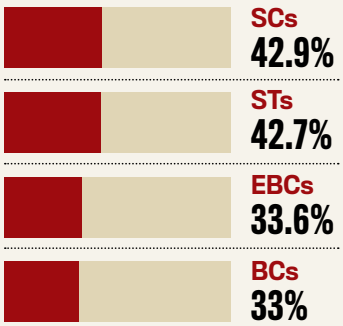
PICTURE OF POVERTY

TOTAL NO. OF HOUSEHOLDS
27.67 MILLION

EARNING < ₹6,000 A MONTH
9.44 MILLION (34.13%)

EARNING >₹50,000 A MONTH
1.08 MILLION (3.9%)

LIVING IN POVERTY



WHAT NITISH HAS PROMISED

₹2 lakh
One-time financial assistance to BPL households

₹1 lakh
Additional funds to 63,840 homeless families, mostly Dalits, to build houses

₹2.5 lakh crore
Cost to the exchequer over the next five years

THE SOCIAL PROFILE

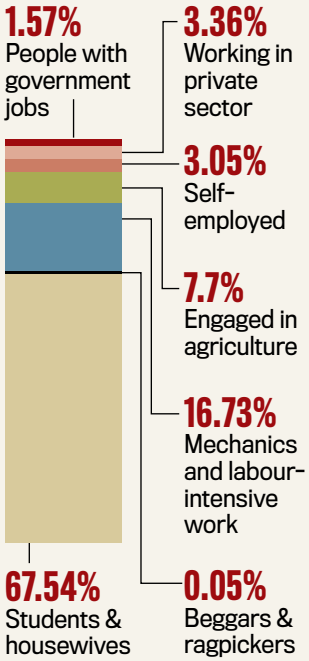
LITERACY RATE
79.7%

EDUCATED UP TO CLASS 5
22.67%

GRADUATES APART FROM DOCTORS AND ENGINEERS
6.11%

OCCUPATIONAL BREAK-UP

(% of Bihar's population)



Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

firmly in his party's favour and cement a place for himself at the centre of OBC politics. "The communities that will benefit the most are expected to prefer the political formation, in this case the Nitish Kumar-led grand alliance, for a quid pro quo electoral payback," says a senior JD(U) member of the Legislative Council. Women are another constituency Nitish has nurtured, wooing them with welfare schemes, educational incentives, prohibition and quotas in panchayats and jobs. Together, they should put Nitish on a strong wicket.

More than anything, however, the twin-edged sword of the caste survey and quota hike is expected to give Nitish and INDIA a strong narrative to take on the BJP's rich arsenal of Hindutva, backward class, nationalist and welfarist politics. "We know our caste arithmetic alone cannot counter Modi. But, now the enhanced reservation is expected to give us a strong